Stage 2: 3 months after

Bone graft for a cleft in the gum: the three stages

This model shows the same jaw about 3 months after the bone graft. New bone fills the gap, and the gum has healed over it.

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the 3 months after model

Whole jaw: new bone fills the gap

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Whole jaw: new bone fills the gap

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the 3 months after model

Gum taken off: new bone in the gap

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Gum taken off: new bone in the gap

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the 3 months after model

From below: the healed gum

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

From below: the healed gum

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the 3 months after model

Left side: the eye tooth above the new bone

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Left side: the eye tooth above the new bone

What has changed

The graft fills the gap from the floor of the nose down to the gum. It joins the two parts of the upper jaw.[1,2]

The surgeon closed the gum over the graft with stitches. If the wound opens, you can lose some of the graft. Surgeons close the gum with care, because a wound that opens is the main problem after this operation.[3,4]

The eye tooth is still in the bone. It is a little lower than before. Over the next months it moves down toward the graft.[5,6]

Checks after surgery

You will have an X-ray at about 3 to 6 months. It shows how well the new bone has taken.[7,8] Some of the graft shrinks over time. Teeth that move into the graft help keep the bone.[9,10]

The hip

Your hip can be sore for a while after the surgeon takes the bone. In one study, children went back to school about 2 weeks after surgery.[11]

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